

NEW HORIZONS

Space probe

Pluto as seen by New Horizons probe

DATA FILE



SIZE: 2.7 m (8.9 ft) wide



DATE OF LAUNCH: 19 January 2006



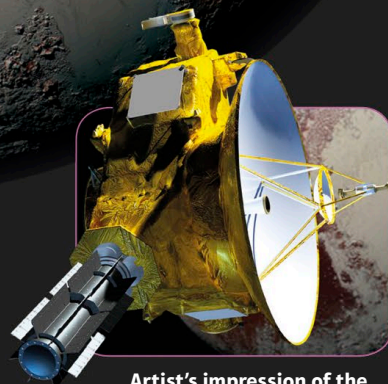
MISSION DURATION: Ongoing



SPACE AGENCY: NASA

New Horizons
raced through
space at a speed
of up to 14.5 km
(9 miles)
per second.

When New Horizons was launched in January 2006, its destination – Pluto – was the ninth planet of our Solar System, but by the time it arrived in July 2015, the tiny globe had been demoted to the status of a dwarf planet. The space probe has discovered Pluto to be a strange world, with mountains of ice and smooth plains of frozen nitrogen and carbon monoxide.



Artist's impression of the
New Horizons probe